



Presented by The High End

CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

Two Round 71-Inch Towers, Battlemented Crowns & a Walk-Through Gate

Two round stone towers and a gate wall with an arch your child walks through standing up.

AGES
4–12

BOXES
3 Refrigerator Boxes

TIME
5–6 Hours

DIFF
Advanced ***

PIECES
13 pcs

CARDBOARD NEEDED:

3 Refrigerator Boxes (sides at least 30" × 66" (76 × 168 cm))

FINISHED SIZE:

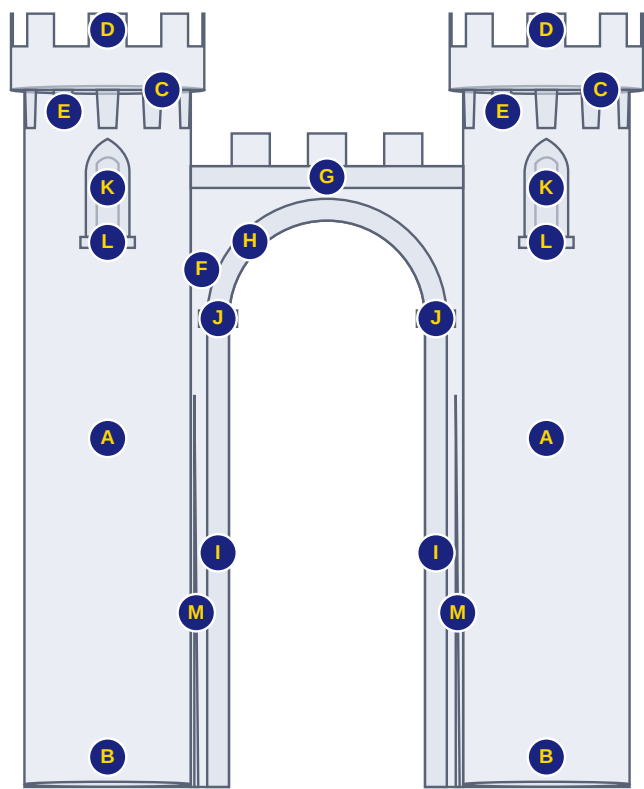
58" wide × 71" tall × 21" deep (147 × 180 × 53 cm); gate opening 18" wide × 52" tall (46 × 132 cm)

MISSION GOAL:

Build the castle in the cover photo: two round towers 71" high, each with a battlemented crown on 12 tan corbels and an arrow slit, joined by a grey stone gate wall with 3 merlons, a ledge, and a tan-trimmed gate 52" tall that a child walks through.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

The finished build, front view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.

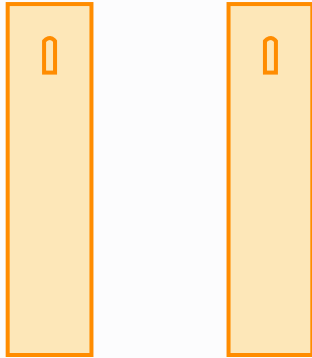


EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD			
A	TOWER HALF 25" × 64" (64 × 163 cm)	CUT ×4	
B	TOWER BASE DISC 15.25" × 15.25" (39 × 39 cm)		CUT ×2
C	TOWER LID 17.75" × 17.75" (45 × 45 cm)	CUT ×2	
D	CROWN STRIP 29" × 7" (74 × 18 cm)		CUT ×4
E	CORBEL BLOCK 9" × 2" (23 × 5 cm)	CUT ×24	
F	GATE WALL 28" × 60" (71 × 152 cm)		CUT ×2
G	LEDGE STRIP 25" × 2" (64 × 5 cm)	CUT ×1	
H	ARCH TRIM 22" × 11" (56 × 28 cm)		CUT ×1
I	JAMB TRIM 2" × 43" (5 × 109 cm)	CUT ×2	
J	IMPOST BLOCK 3.5" × 1.5" (9 × 4 cm)		CUT ×2
K	SLIT FRAME 4" × 9" (10 × 23 cm)	CUT ×2	
L	SLIT SILL 5" × 1" (13 × 3 cm)		CUT ×2
M	GATE BRACE 12" × 36" (30 × 91 cm)	CUT ×2	

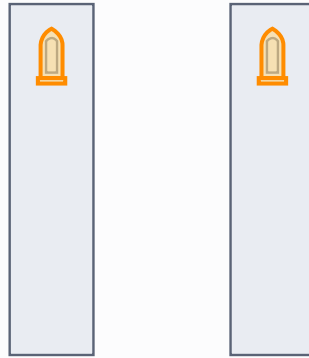
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

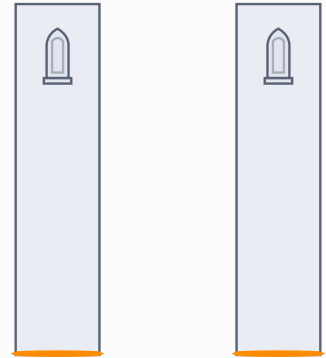
3 ROLL THE TOWER TUBES



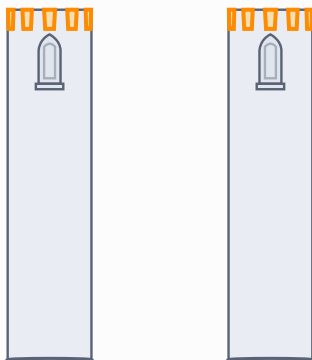
4 FIT THE SLIT WINDOWS



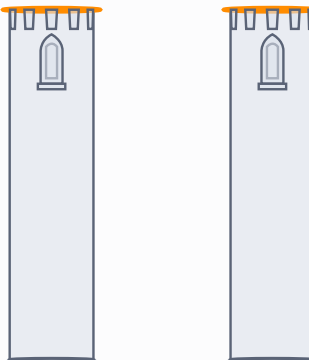
5 WEIGHT THE TOWER BASES



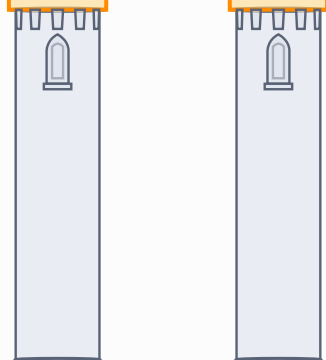
6 ADD THE CORBEL BLOCKS



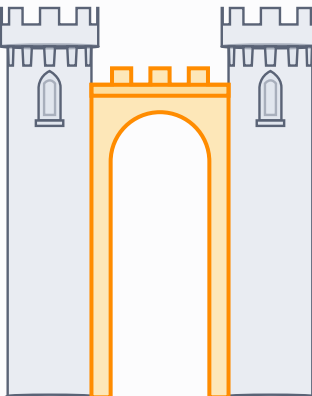
7 FIT THE TOWER LIDS



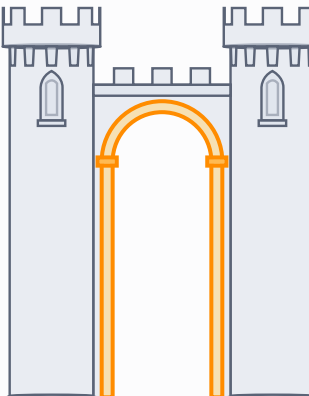
8 BUILD THE CROWNS



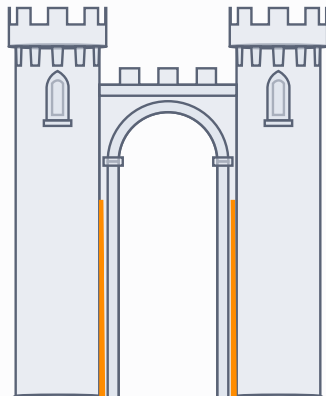
9 BUILD THE GATE WALL



10 TRIM THE GATE



11 STAND UP THE CASTLE

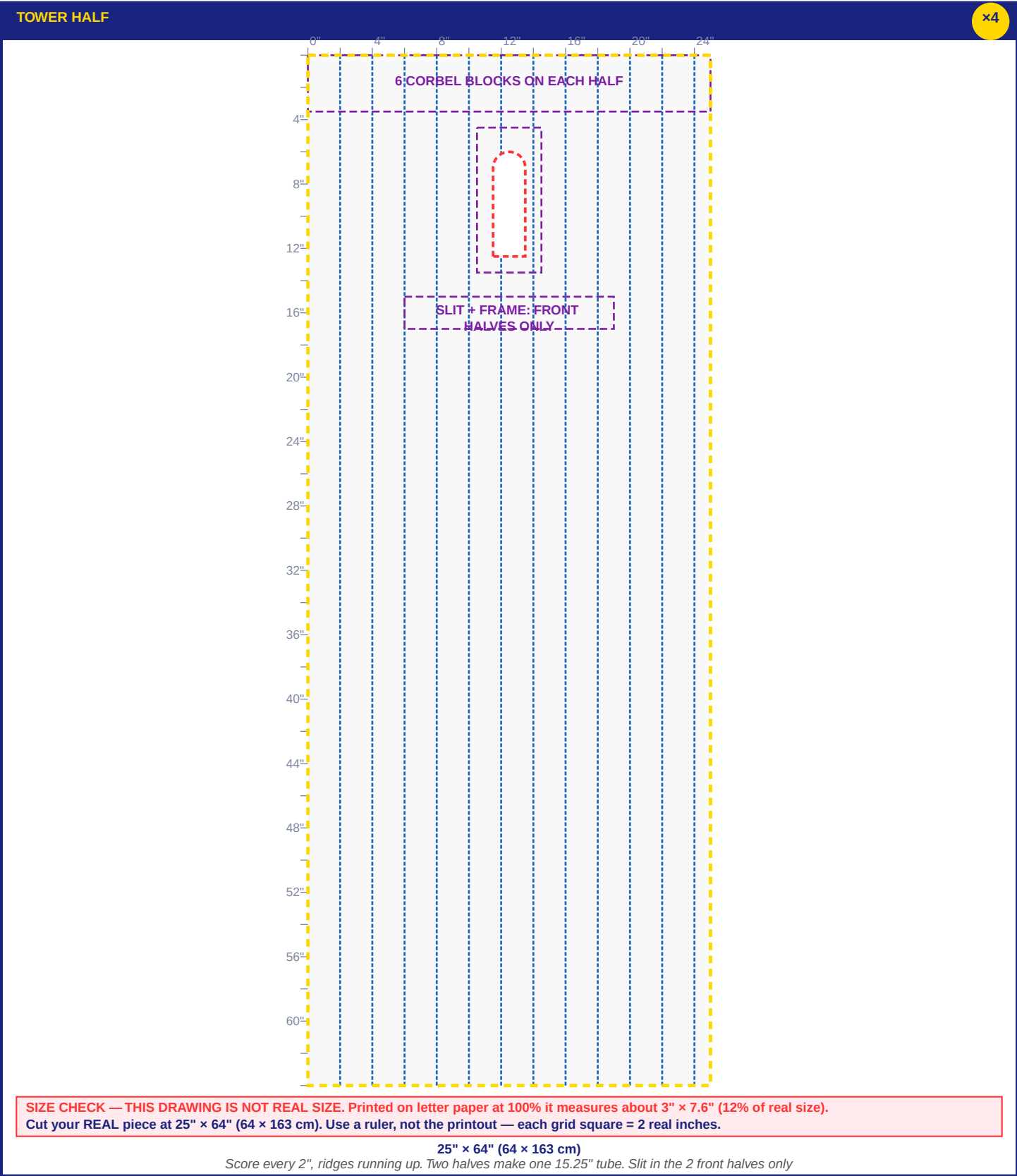




TOWER HALF

25" × 64" (64 × 163 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4



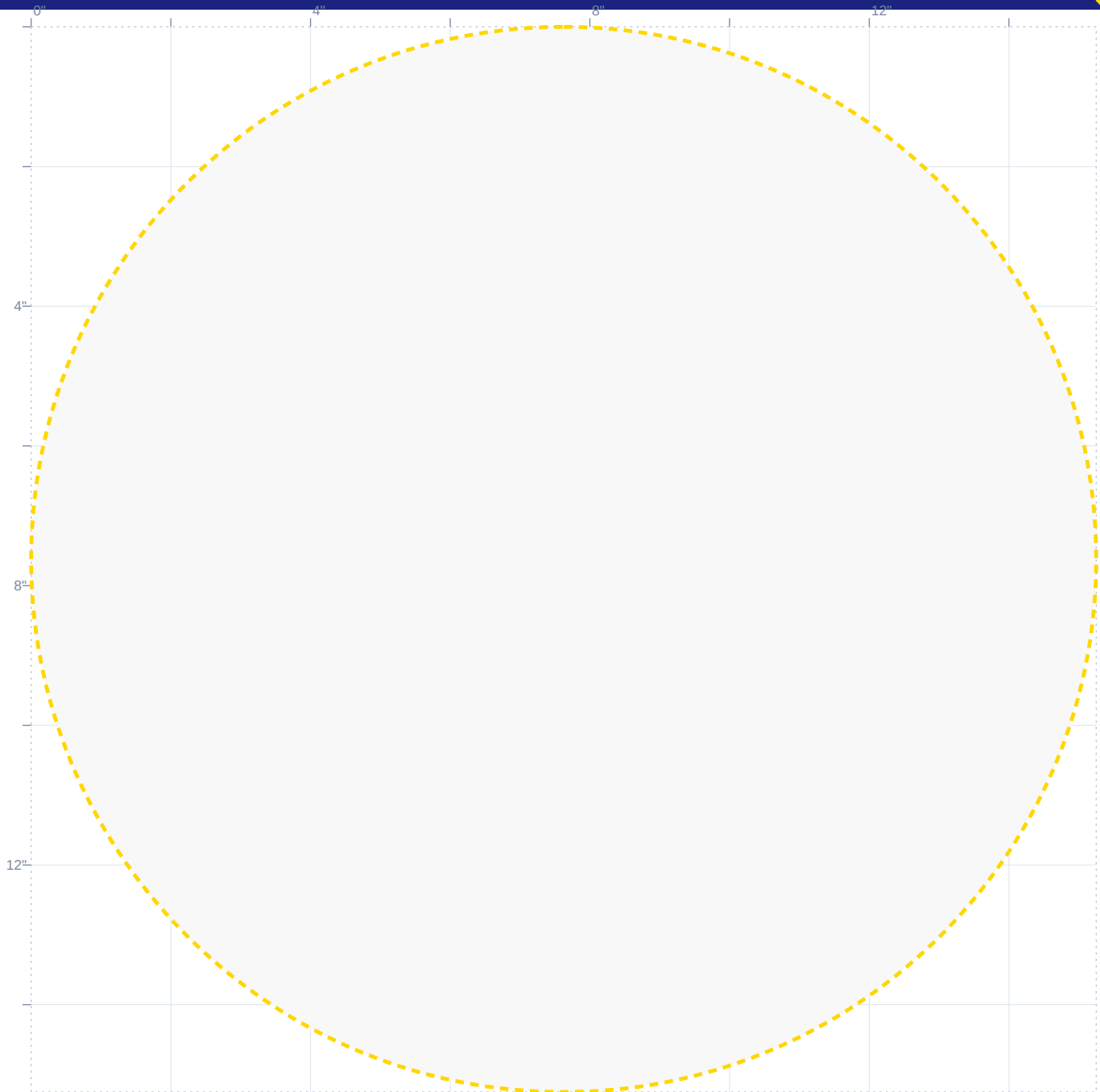
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through	CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: Score every 2", ridges running up. Two halves make one 15.25" tube. Slit in the 2 front halves only

TOWER BASE DISC

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (45% of real size).
Cut your **REAL** piece at 15.25" × 15.25" (39 × 39 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

A circle 15.25" across. Pin a string at the centre and swing a pencil right round at 7.6" (half of 15.25"). Check it against the bottom of your rolled tube and trim until it just slips inside.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

15.25" × 15.25" (39 × 39 cm)*Circle — fits inside the bottom of the tower tube***MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:**

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is **NOT** a rectangle.

NOTE: Fits inside the bottom of each tube; the weight sits on it



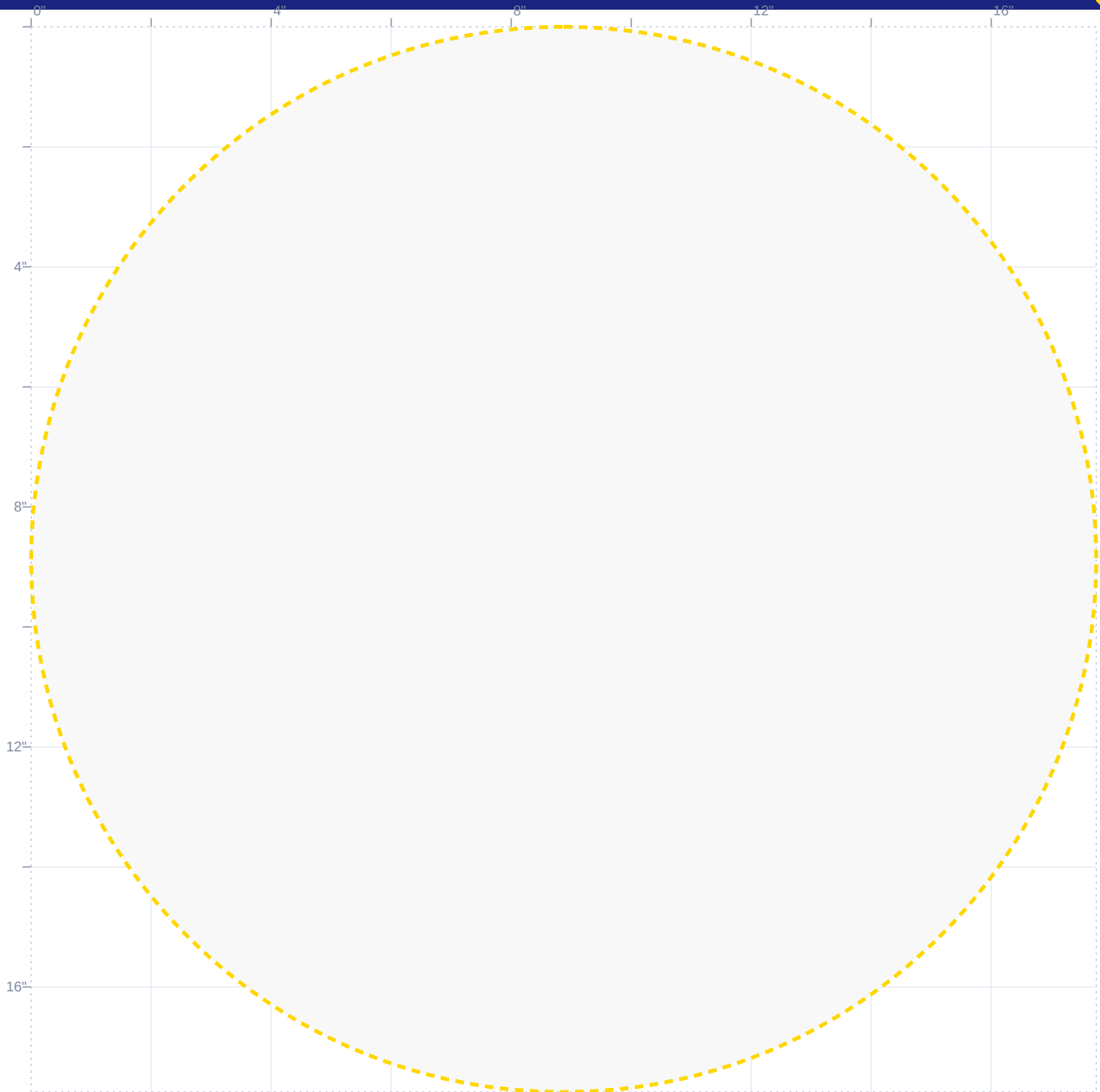
TOWER LID

17.75" × 17.75" (45 × 45 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

TOWER LID

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (39% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 17.75" × 17.75" (45 × 45 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

A circle 17.75" across. Pin a string at the centre and swing a pencil right round at 8.9" (half of 17.75"). It overhangs the 15.25" tube by about 1.25" all round.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

17.75" × 17.75" (45 × 45 cm)

Circle — the lid of the tower; overhangs the tube all round

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: The lid on top of each tube; overhangs it about 1.25" all round



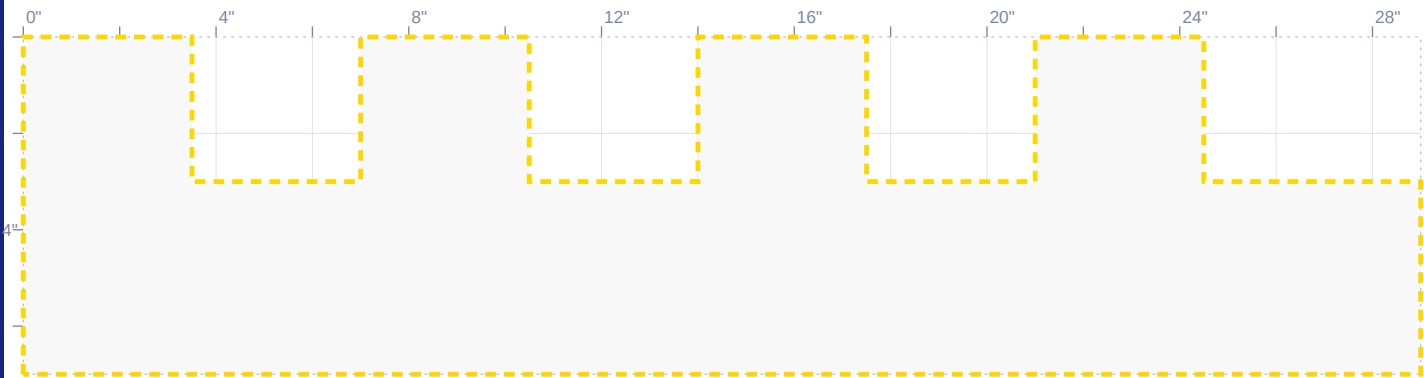
CROWN STRIP

29" × 7" (74 × 18 cm) | Cut ×4

CUT
x4

CROWN STRIP

x4



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.8" (25% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 29" × 7" (74 × 18 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Draw a line 3" down from the top edge. From the LEFT end, mark every 3.5" along the top: keep blocks 1, 3, 5 and 7 full height and cut blocks 2, 4, 6 and 8 down to the line. The last 1" stays at the line too: it is the overlap tab.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

29" × 7" (74 × 18 cm)
Crown strip — 4 merlons along the top, a low overlap tab at the right end

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: 2 per tower, joined end to end into a ring round the Tower Lid



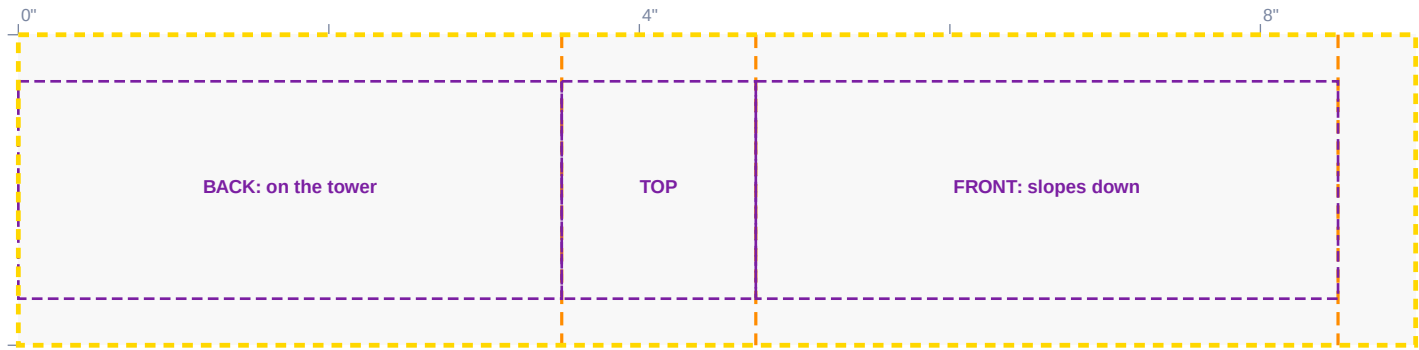
CORBEL BLOCK

9" × 2" (23 × 5 cm) | Cut ×24

CUT
x24

CORBEL BLOCK

x24



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.6" (81% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 9" × 2" (23 × 5 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

9" × 2" (23 × 5 cm)
12 per tower. Folds into a small 3-sided block under the crown

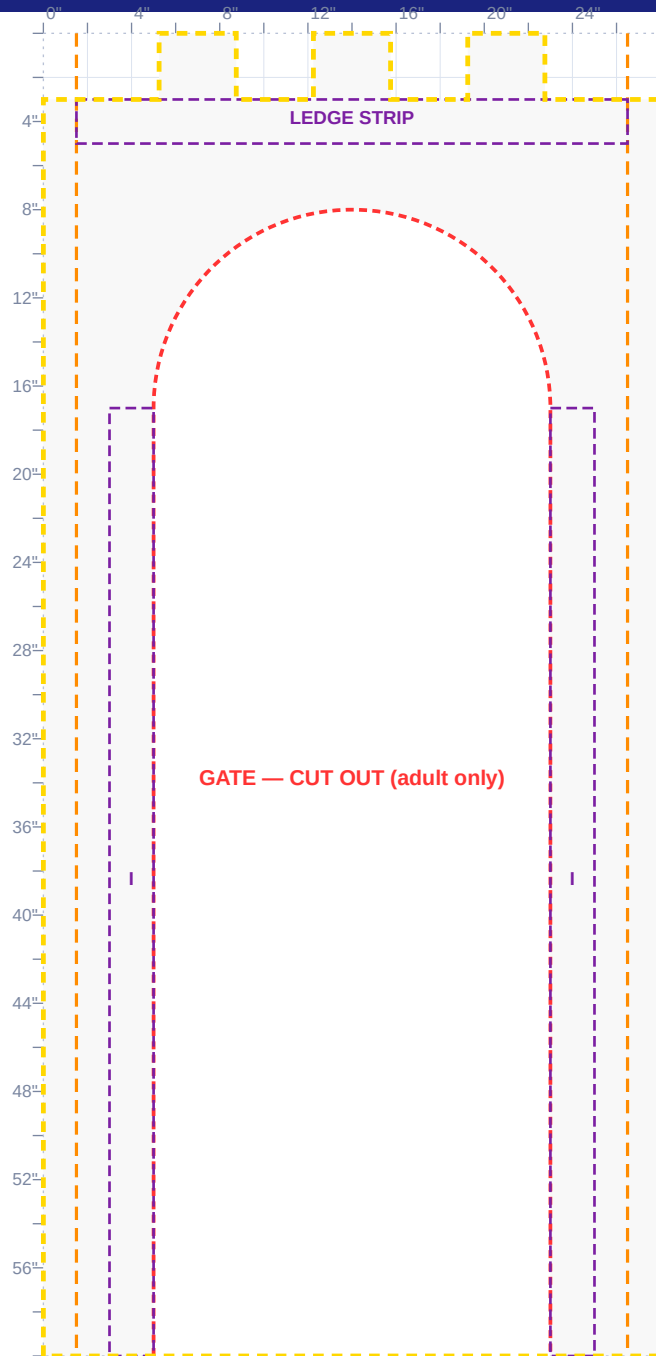
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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NOTE: 12 per tower. Folds into a small 3-sided block under the crown

GATE WALL

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 3.2" × 6.9" (11% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 28" × 60" (71 × 152 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Draw a line 3" down from the top. Mark the centre of the top edge and measure 8.8" each way from it, then split that 17.5" into 5 blocks of 3.5". Keep blocks 1, 3 and 5 full height; cut everything else down to the line, out to both ends.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

28" × 60" (71 × 152 cm)

Gate wall — 3 merlons centred on the top; cut the gate out of the bottom

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: Cut 2 the same and glue them face to face. The 1.5" side strips fold back onto the towers



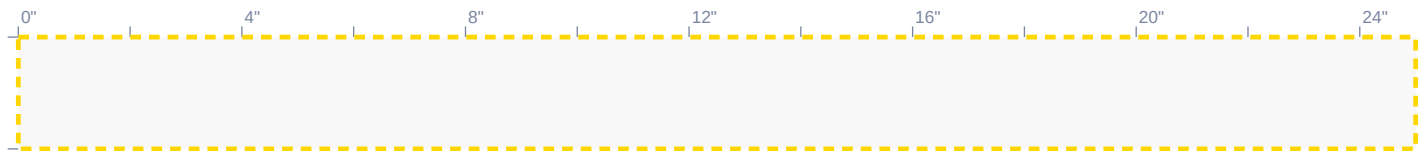
LEDGE STRIP

25" × 2" (64 × 5 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

LEDGE STRIP

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 0.6" (29% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 25" × 2" (64 × 5 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

25" × 2" (64 × 5 cm)
Runs across the front of the gate wall just under the 3 merlons

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Runs across the front of the gate wall just under the 3 merlons



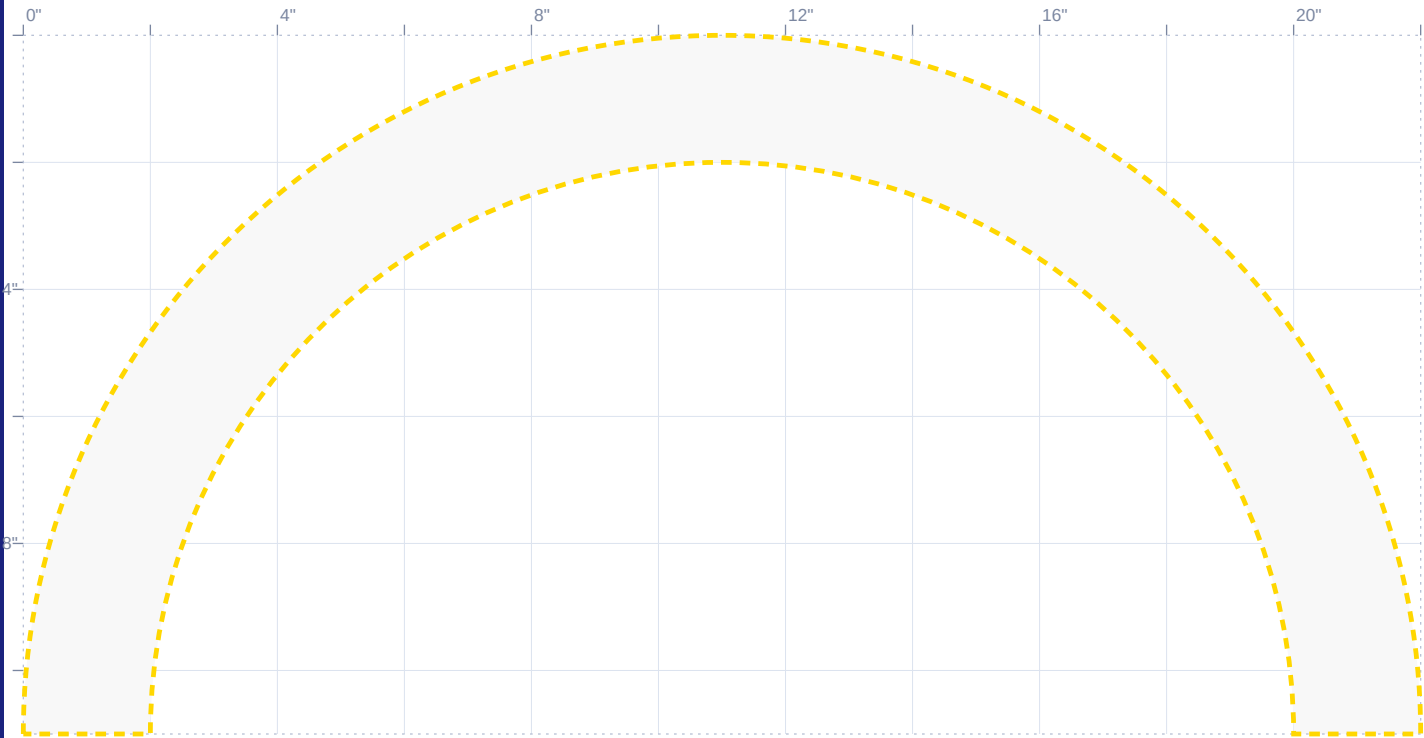
ARCH TRIM

22" × 11" (56 × 28 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

ARCH TRIM

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (33% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 22" × 11" (56 × 28 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the middle of the bottom edge. With a string and pencil pinned there, draw a half circle 11" out and a second one 9" out. Cut along both curves; the band between them is 2" wide and fits round the top of the gate.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

22" × 11" (56 × 28 cm)

Arch trim — half a ring, flat along the bottom

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Bare tan band round the top of the gate



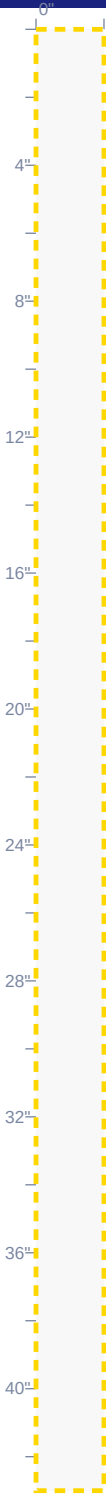
JAMB TRIM

2" × 43" (5 × 109 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

JAMB TRIM

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 0.4" × 7.6" (18% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 2" × 43" (5 × 109 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

2" × 43" (5 × 109 cm)

Bare tan strips up both sides of the gate, from the floor to where the top bends

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Bare tan strips up both sides of the gate, from the floor to where the top bends



IMPOST BLOCK

3.5" × 1.5" (9 × 4 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

IMPOST BLOCK

x2

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.1" (208% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 3.5" × 1.5" (9 × 4 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

3.5" × 1.5" (9 × 4 cm)

Covers each join where the trim band meets a jamb

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Covers each join where the trim band meets a jamb



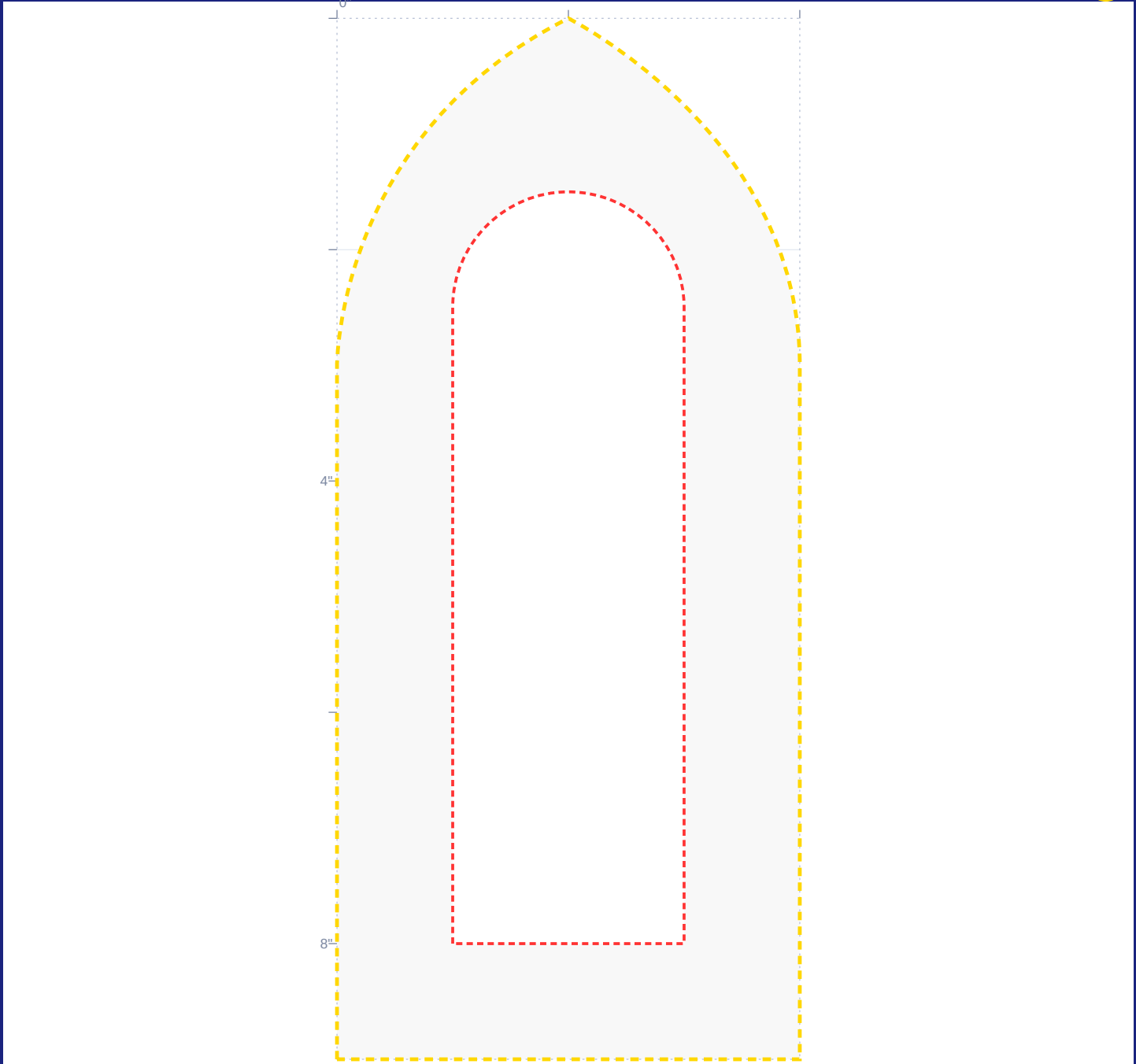
SLIT FRAME

4" × 9" (10 × 23 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

SLIT FRAME

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 3.1" × 6.9" (77% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 4" × 9" (10 × 23 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Mark both side edges 3" down from the top, and the centre of the top edge. Draw a curve from each side mark up to the centre mark, bulging outward, so they meet in a point. Then cut out the slit window shown.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

4" × 9" (10 × 23 cm)
Slit frame — pointed top, straight sides; the slit is cut out of the middle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)
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NOTE: Raised frame round each arrow slit



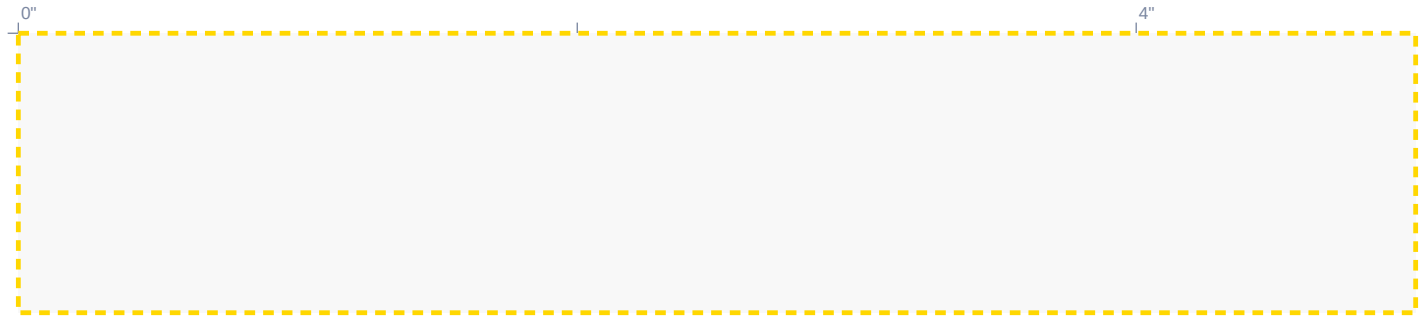
SLIT SILL

5" × 1" (13 × 3 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

SLIT SILL

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.5" (146% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 5" × 1" (13 × 3 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

5" × 1" (13 × 3 cm)
Small shelf under each slit frame

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Small shelf under each slit frame



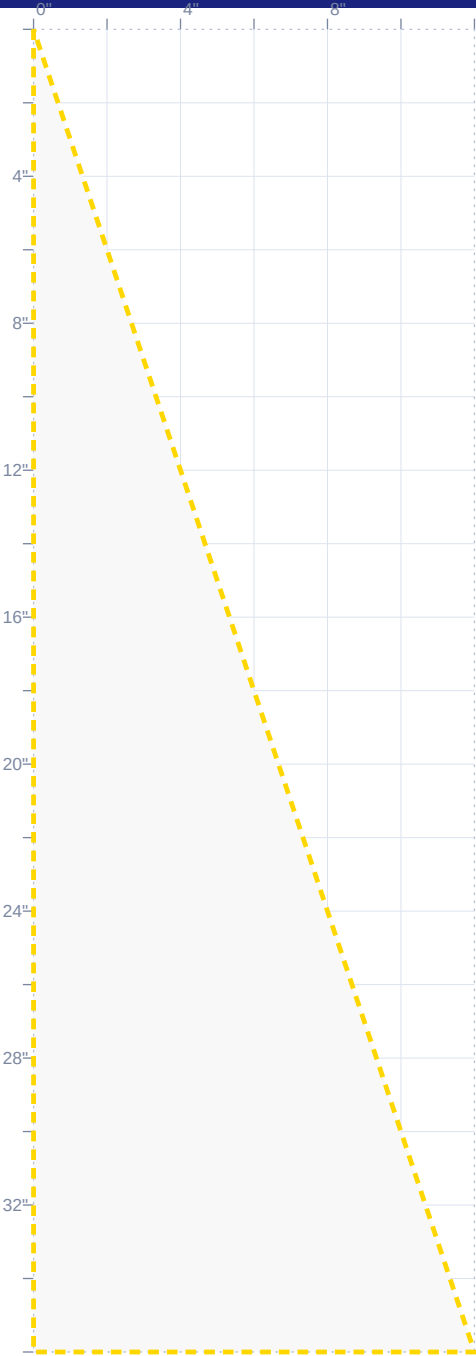
GATE BRACE

12" × 36" (30 × 91 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

GATE BRACE

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 2.3" × 6.9" (19% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 12" × 36" (30 × 91 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
From one corner measure 36" up one edge and 12" along the bottom edge. Join the two marks with one straight line and cut along it. The square corner goes at the floor, against the wall.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

12" × 36" (30 × 91 cm)
Brace — a right-angled triangle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Hidden behind the gate wall; stops the castle tipping

WHAT YOU NEED — CASTLE FORTRESS ALPHA

CARDBOARD PIECES — 13 TOTAL (3 Refrigerator Boxes (sides at least 30" × 66" (76 × 168 cm)))

×4 Tower Half 25" × 64" <i>Score every 2", ridges running up. Two halves make one 15.25" tube. Slit in the 2 front halves only</i>	×1 Arch Trim 22" × 11" <i>Bare tan band round the top of the gate</i>
×2 Tower Base Disc 15.25" × 15.25" <i>Fits inside the bottom of each tube; the weight sits on it</i>	×2 Jamb Trim 2" × 43" <i>Bare tan strips up both sides of the gate, from the floor to where the top bends</i>
×2 Tower Lid 17.75" × 17.75" <i>The lid on top of each tube; overhangs it about 1.25" all round</i>	×2 Impost Block 3.5" × 1.5" <i>Covers each join where the trim band meets a jamb</i>
×4 Crown Strip 29" × 7" <i>2 per tower, joined end to end into a ring round the Tower Lid</i>	×2 Slit Frame 4" × 9" <i>Raised frame round each arrow slit</i>
×24 Corbel Block 9" × 2" <i>12 per tower. Folds into a small 3-sided block under the crown</i>	×2 Slit Sill 5" × 1" <i>Small shelf under each slit frame</i>
×2 Gate Wall 28" × 60" <i>Cut 2 the same and glue them face to face. The 1.5" side strips fold back onto the towers</i>	×2 Gate Brace 12" × 36" <i>Hidden behind the gate wall; stops the castle tipping</i>
×1 Ledge Strip 25" × 2" <i>Runs across the front of the gate wall just under the 3 merlons</i>	

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- + 3 refrigerator boxes (free from appliance stores), flattened
- + Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY
- + Packing tape (4+ rolls)
- + Strong glue: hot glue (adult) or PVA craft glue
- + Yardstick, string + pencil
- + Medium grey paint (about 1 quart) + roller or wide brush
- + Dark grey marker for the stone lines
- + Two 5 lb bags of rice or sand (tower weights)
- + Step stool (adult) for the tower tops

FUN FACT!

The blocks under each tower top are called corbels. Real castles used them to push the battlements out past the wall, leaving gaps in the floor so defenders could see straight down to the foot of the tower.

CHALLENGE!

Royal gate guard: one child guards the gate and makes up a password. Everyone else must answer a riddle to walk through. Swap guards every round.

1 STEP 1: MARK OUT THE PIECES

Flatten the 3 refrigerator boxes. Mark template A on 4 of the biggest faces with the cardboard ridges running UP the 64" (163 cm) side: that is the way a tube bends. Mark template F twice, on two more faces. Fit B, C, D, H and M on the next two faces, then E (24 of them), G, I, J, K and L on what is left. Every size is on its template page.

2 STEP 2: CUT OUT THE PIECES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut every piece on its gold outline or red dashes. Cut the arrow slit in 2 of the A pieces only; those 2 are the front halves. Cut the gate out of both F pieces: 18" (46 cm) wide and 52" (132 cm) tall with a round top, open at the bottom so there is nothing to trip over. Cut the slit window out of both K pieces.

SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter. Smooth the gate edge: no jagged cardboard.

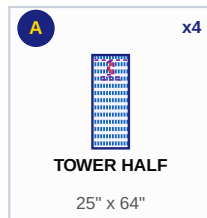
3 STEP 3: ROLL THE TOWER TUBES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Score each Tower Half along its blue lines, every 2" (5 cm), then bend it over a table edge until it curls into a half tube. Stand a front half (with the slit) and a plain half together and overlap their edges 1" (3 cm) at both seams, so they close into a tube 15.25" (39 cm) across. Tape both seams inside and out, floor to top. Make 2 tubes.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the halves, one tapes.

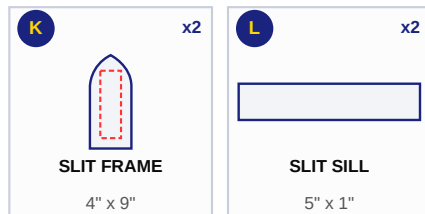
PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



4 STEP 4: FIT THE SLIT WINDOWS

On each front half, glue a Slit Frame over the slit so its window lines up with the slit (purple box on template A), then glue a Slit Sill right under the frame, level and centred. The slit sits high on the tower, just below the top of the tube.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



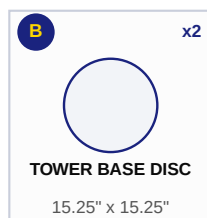
5 STEP 5: WEIGHT THE TOWER BASES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay each tube on its side. Push a Tower Base Disc into the bottom end, flush with the edge, and tape it in all the way round from inside. Put a 5 lb bag of rice or sand into the tube, so it rests on the disc when the tower stands up. Each tower ends up 71" (180 cm) high and only 15.25" (39 cm) across: without the weight in the bottom it tips over easily.

SAFETY: Never skip the weight. No climbing on, hanging on or pulling the towers.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

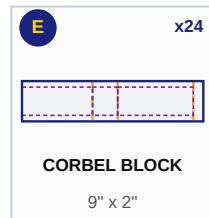


6

STEP 6: ADD THE CORBEL BLOCKS

Fold each Corbel Block on its 3 orange lines into a small 3-sided block: back 3.5" (9 cm), top 1.25" (3 cm), sloping front, with the little end tab tucked inside the back. Tape it closed. Glue 12 round the top of each tube, 4" (10 cm) apart, back flat on the tube and top face level with the top edge of the tube.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

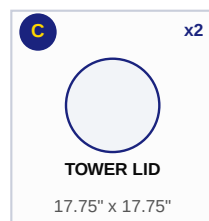


7

STEP 7: FIT THE TOWER LIDS

With the tube still on its side, set a Tower Lid on its top end, centred, so it sticks out about 1.25" (3 cm) all round and rests on the 12 corbel tops. Tape the lid to the tube from underneath, between the corbels, and glue it to each corbel top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



8

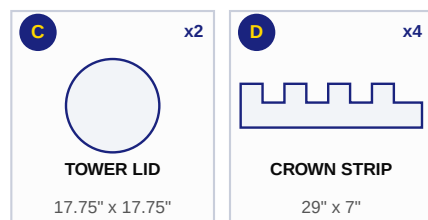
STEP 8: BUILD THE CROWNS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Join 2 Crown Strips end to end into a ring 56" (142 cm) round: the plain 1" (3 cm) tab at the end of each strip tucks behind the first merlon of the other, glued. Stand the tower up. Slip the ring down over the Tower Lid so its bottom edge is level with the underside of the lid, glue it to the lid edge all the way round, then tape inside. Each crown now has 8 merlons. Do the same for the second tower.

SAFETY: Adult on a step stool for the tower tops.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

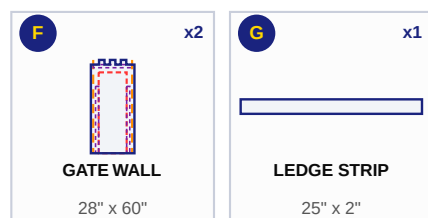


9

STEP 9: BUILD THE GATE WALL

Glue the two Gate Walls face to face, edges, merlons and gate openings lined up, so the wall is two layers thick. Fold the 1.5" (4 cm) strip at each side back along the orange lines. Glue the Ledge Strip across the front in its purple box, right under the 3 merlons.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

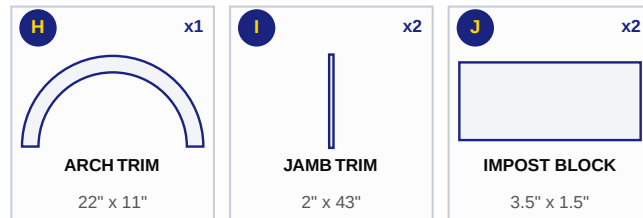


10

STEP 10: TRIM THE GATE

Glue a Jamb Trim up each side of the gate, flush with its edge, from the floor 43" (109 cm) up to where the top starts to bend (the purple I boxes on template F). Glue the Arch Trim round the top of the gate with its ends standing on the jambs. Glue an Impost Block across each of those two joins, sticking out a little each side. Leave all of these bare tan cardboard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



11

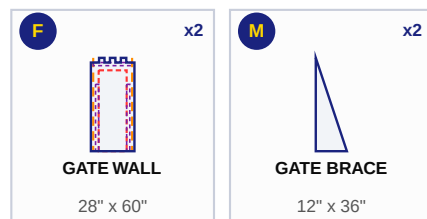
STEP 11: STAND UP THE CASTLE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand the two towers 25" (64 cm) apart, slits facing forward. Set the Gate Wall between them, its bottom on the floor, and glue and tape each folded side strip to the side of a tower. Then tape the 2 Gate Braces upright behind the wall, one beside each side of the gate, square corner at the floor and tall edge flat against the back of the wall. The braces are hidden from the front and stop the castle tipping forward or back.

SAFETY: Two people. Push each tower top gently: it must rock back, not tip.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

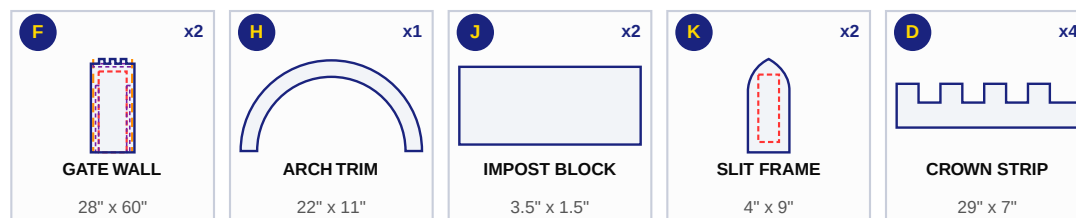


12

STEP 12: PAINT IT STONE GREY

Paint the towers, the crowns (strips and lid edges), the gate wall, the ledge, the slit frames and the sills medium grey. Leave the corbels, the Arch Trim, the two jambs and the Impost Blocks bare tan cardboard, exactly like the cover photo. Let it dry.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

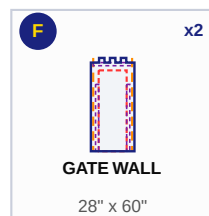


13

STEP 13: DRAW THE STONE BLOCKS

With the dark grey marker draw the stone rows on every grey surface: level lines 2.5" (6 cm) apart all the way up each tower and the gate wall, then short upright lines every 4" (10 cm) along each row, shifted 2" (5 cm) on every other row so the blocks are staggered like bricks. Keep the lines soft and slightly uneven. Do not draw on the tan trim or the corbels.

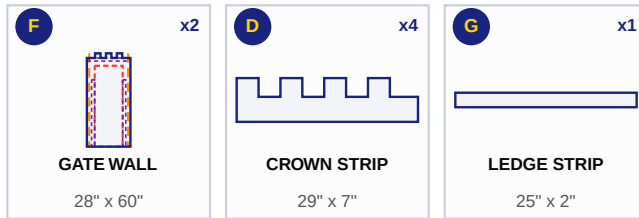
PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



14

STEP 14: QUALITY CHECK

Two round towers stand 71" (180 cm) high, each with an overhanging crown of 8 merlons on 12 tan corbels and a framed arrow slit with a sill. Between them stands the grey gate wall with 3 merlons on a ledge and tan trim round the gate, and a child walks upright through the gate (children up to about 50" (127 cm) tall; taller ones duck). Grey stone blocks on everything else. Compare to the cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP**QUALITY CHECK!**

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations